

Personal trading plan

Discretionary — running on the algorithm's rails

I trade the setups by hand, because the evidence says my context read beats the machine's filter. But I run on the algorithm's rails for everything the machine does better than me: **sizing, stops, exits, and stopping.**

The split, stated once so I don't forget it.

My edge is **SELECTION** — picking which of the day's setups is the real one.

The machine's edge is **DISCIPLINE** — executing without mood.

The worst version of me reads the context right and gives it back through size, revenge, or skipping the boring ones.

Live from R1,000 · Exness ZAR · GBPUSD, EURUSD, NZDUSD · max 1 trade per pair, 3 per day

Every figure in this plan is read from the live engine config at build time, so the plan cannot drift from the algorithm.

The five rules

This page is the whole plan. Everything after it is the detail behind it.

1

I trade only what is on the card.

If the setup does not tick the card, there is no trade — no matter how it looks, how long I have waited, or what I missed yesterday. **“Nothing today” is a result, not a failure.** Outside the killzone there is no trade. Past my daily cap there is no trade.

Because the machine is never bored, and I am.

2

Size comes from the table. Never from the feeling.

Base lot is whatever my equity tier says. I may apply **one** 1.25× step, and only for a named confirmation from the list. Nothing else changes my size — not conviction, not a streak, not making back yesterday. Risk never exceeds **8%** on one trade.

Because sizing on feeling is the fastest way to give back an edge — and the record says that feeling is mostly not informative.

3

Stop and target are set before I enter, and I do not renegotiate them.

Stop beyond the intermediate swing, capped at **10 pips**. Target is the nearest qualifying draw at **30 pips** or more. I trail on the ladder. **I take the whole position off at the draw** — the continuation afterwards is a new trade with a new entry, not a reason to hold.

Because every single exit modification tested lost money: –49%, –75%, and one version bankrupted the test account.

4

I add only on the pyramid conditions. I never add to rescue.

An add requires **+15 pips already in profit**, at least 30 pips of target still remaining, and the higher timeframe still agreeing. Maximum **3 legs**. **If the trade is against me, there is no add. Ever.** That is averaging down wearing a pyramid's clothes.

Because the two look identical in the moment and opposite on the account.

5

The breakers are mine and they are not negotiable.

2 stop-outs, or –6% on the day → I am done for the day. 5 losses in a row → done. –10% from session open → flat, day over. –15% from my equity peak → **10 calendar days off (mine to enforce by hand below R3,000).** **Never a new trade in the same dollar direction as one that just stopped out.**

Because revenge and tilt are the only things that can actually end the account — and blocking correlated exposure alone lifted profit factor from 2.47 to 2.98 in testing.

The detail

When I trade

Pairs	GBPUSD, EURUSD, NZDUSD — nothing else
London Open	03:00 – 05:00 New York time
New York AM	07:00 – 10:00 New York time
NZDUSD	London Open only — NY AM was a confirmed drain
Hard block	No new entry in the last 15 minutes of a killzone
Daily cap	1 trade per pair, 3 total , per day

The cap is part of Rule 1. Three is the ceiling, not the target — most days should be one or zero.

The setup card — Rule 1

Every box must tick before I click. No partial cards.

Direction and pair

- Dollar direction is clear (not flat) on H1 structure
- The pair is the one the dollar and EURGBP select
- **Golden rule:** short is GBPUSD, long is EURUSD — unless the cross says otherwise

Structure

- There is a consolidation / dealing range I can point at
- One side was swept and price closed **back inside** (the Judas)
- I am entering on a PD array — gap, order block or breaker — on the **retrace**, not the sweep leg

Quality — I want at least TWO of these four

- The sweep ran **yesterday's high or low** (55% / 53% vs 45% baseline, 115 trades)
- The **H4 candle already swept and rejected** (50.4% win rate, 137 trades)
- My entry sits at an HTF gap's midpoint
- It is **Monday or Tuesday of NFP week** (62.5% / 52.1%)

Target

- At least **three different** sources agree at my target, within ~8 pips (*one source: PF 0.02 · two: 0.20 · three: 6.70*)
- Target is ≥ 30 pips away and $\geq 1.2\times$ my stop
- It is the **nearest** qualifying draw — I am not reaching past it

Nothing in the way

- No opposing HTF gap sitting between my entry and my target
- No high-impact news in the window
- I hold no open position in the same dollar direction

If fewer than two quality boxes tick, or the target needs fewer than three sources — there is no trade. That is the card doing its job.

Size — Rule 2 in numbers

Account equity	Lot	Per pip	10-pip stop	30-pip target
R1,000 – R3,000	0.02	R3.70	–R37	+R111
R3,000 – R6,000	0.05	R9.25	–R92	+R278
R6,000+	0.09	R16.65	–R167	+R500

The **1.25× step** — one only, and only for one of these:

- the sweep ran prior-day high/low
- H4 turtle soup already fired my way
- four or more sources agree at the target
- the trade follows the golden rule
- entry is at an HTF gap's midpoint

Below R3,000 there is no step at all. The multipliers are disabled under R3,000 in the engine and they are disabled for me too.

■ ■ The account **cannot** size below 0.02 lots. If I draw under R1,000 the tier table says 0.01 but the broker floor is 0.02 — so my worst day is about **R74 (two stops)**, not the R55 figure in the old notes. The –6% daily cap is what actually contains it.

Exit — Rule 3 in numbers

Trade progress	Where my stop goes
Entry	Beyond the intermediate swing, capped at 10 pips
+10 pips	Breakeven
+20 pips	Entry +10
+40 pips	Entry +35
+60 pips	Entry +55
every +20 after	lock (milestone – 5)

Target: the nearest qualifying draw, 30 pips minimum. Aim at the **3-day pool** — reached 58% and 61% of the time. The 30-day and 60-day pools are reached about one time in five; they are extensions, not objectives.

At the draw I am flat. No trailing past it, no half-position running on.

Pyramiding — Rule 4 in numbers

An add is permitted only when **all four** are true:

#	Condition
1	Price is ≥ 15 pips in profit on the existing position
2	≥ 30 pips of target still remains
3	The dollar still agrees and at least one higher timeframe still confirms the draw
4	I am on leg 1 or 2 — maximum 3 legs , each the same size

Each leg carries its **own** stop, placed structurally, capped at 10 pips.

An add is never a rescue. If the trade is against me the answer is no. There is no version of this rule where being underwater permits another entry.

The breakers — Rule 5 in numbers

Trigger	Action
–6% of the day's opening equity	No new entries for the rest of the day
2 stop-outs in a day	Same — I close the laptop
5 losses in a row	Done for the day
–10% from session open	Close everything, day over
–15% from equity peak	10 calendar days off. No exceptions — but ■■■ MANUAL below R3,000
Just stopped out	No new trade in that same dollar direction

■■■ The –15% halt is MINE to enforce until R3,000. The engine swaps the percentage breaker for a hard floor at R500 while the account is small, because –15% at R1,000 is four losses and it would halt almost permanently. Sensible for the machine — but nothing automatic stops me at –15%; the next automatic stop is R500, a 51.8% loss. At R850 I close the laptop for ten days because I said I would.

On that last one: EURUSD, GBPUSD and NZDUSD are one dollar bet wearing three names. A long EURUSD and a short GBPUSD is the same position twice, with two spreads. Blocking that is measured to be worth roughly half a point of profit factor.

The routine

Before the session — 15 minutes

#	Step
1	Mark the daily gaps. Nearest unfilled daily gap above and below price, per pair, and how far each is. A daily gap fills 90–96% of the time over a median 5–9 days — this is my map of where price is likely to travel, not a direction signal on its own.
2	Read the dollar. H1 structure as of yesterday's close — the previous day's price action tells the story.
3	Read the cross. EURGBP decides which of EUR/GBP to trade. The counters say the cross does more filtering work than the dollar.
4	Mark the range. Yesterday's high/low, the Asian range, the previous session's high/low.
5	Check the calendar. High-impact news in the window = no trade.
6	Write down what I expect — one sentence, before price moves. This is how I find out later whether I read it right or told myself a story afterwards.

During the session

- Watch for the card. Do not hunt for it.
- 1 trade per pair. 3 total. Then stop looking.
- When it triggers: enter, set stop, set target, **walk away from the chart**.
- Manage only at the ladder levels. Nothing between them needs me.

After the session — 10 minutes

Log every trade. The five fields that matter:

Field	Why
Which quality boxes ticked	Builds the live version of the evidence tables
Toward or away from the daily gap , and how far	The one live open question — see below
Did I follow all five rules? Yes / No	This is the real score
If no — which one, and what was I feeling	The pattern is the point
Outcome in R , not rands	Rands make small accounts feel like failures

Rule-following is scored separately from profit. A losing trade that followed all five rules is a **good** trade. A winning trade that broke one is a **bad** trade that happened to pay — and that is the one that teaches the worst habit.

The one thing I am still collecting data on

Trades pointing **at** an unfilled daily gap won more often in both halves of the backtest — **+5.1 and +4.2 points**. Right sign, right size, twice over, which very little in this project managed. It could not be *proven* because it needs roughly four times the data we have.

So I note it, and I do **not** force trades around it. After a few months of live trades I will have something nobody had before: a real record of whether the toward-the-gap setups are my signature moves.

When I break a rule

It will happen. What matters is what happens next.

#	
1	Write it down the same day — which rule, what I was feeling, what it cost.
2	No make-back trade. The rule was broken; adding a second break does not repair the first.
3	Two breaks in a week → one full week on demo. Not as punishment — because two breaks means the rules are not yet automatic, and automatic is the whole point.

Review

When	What I look at
Weekly	Rule-following score. Not P&L. The score.
Monthly	My live win rate and profit factor against the algorithm's 43.9% and 4.01 . If I am below it after 50+ trades, the honest answer is the machine should be running this and I should be supervising.
At 50 trades	Re-run the analysis on my own trade log — which of my quality boxes actually predicted anything, tested the same way the algorithm was: controls, and both halves.

Baseline to measure myself against: the algorithm produced **736 trades** over 2022–2025 — win rate **43.9%**, profit factor **4.01**, worst drawdown **–13.24%**, turning R1,000 into R132,020 withdrawn plus R8,555 working capital.